



Bavarians

THE LARGEST REGION IN GERMANY is called Bavaria, but Bavarian dialects and architecture can be found in parts of Germany, the Austrian Tyrol, and even South Tyrol in Italy. The folk customs of this area are particularly rich – yodelling, the alpenhorn, many different kinds of dance, and a variety of national costumes all originate in this region.

A rich heritage

Local governments support cultural organizations in their efforts to keep Bavarian traditions alive. No subsidies are necessary, however, to promote Bavarian foods: beer, meatballs, and sausages are still as popular as ever.

TOWN SQUARE

The town of Lindau nestles on an island on the shores of Lake Constance, Germany's biggest lake. During the Middle Ages prosperous merchants lived here. Their brightly painted, half-timbered houses overlooking picturesque town squares are very popular with tourists.

OKTOBERFEST

The Oktoberfest has been held in Munich every year since 1810 when it was instituted to celebrate a royal wedding. It is an enormous festival with over six million visitors annually. The mayor opens the event by tapping a keg of beer and declaring "O'zapft is" which means "it's been tapped".



BRASS BAND

Jolly Bavarian "oom-pah" music is traditionally played outdoors by a brass band. It features at celebrations, – most famously at Munich's boisterous Oktoberfest.

